

Long-Distance Caregiving Checklist

Build a practical support net when you cannot quickly get to your parent in person.

Privacy note: This checklist is for your personal/family use. Parent Stay Home does not receive, save, store, or see anything you type into the web version. Keep completed copies only where appropriate and share only with trusted or authorized people.

Parent and primary helper information

Parent's full name	
Date updated	
Parent's street address	
City	
State / ZIP	
Primary out-of-town helper	
Primary helper phone/email	
Best local person to call first	
Best local person phone/email	

Local support contacts

List nearby people who may be able to check on your parent, meet a responder, unlock a door, pick up something urgent, or help with a practical need. Ask permission before listing someone as a helper.

#	Name	Relationship / role	Phone	Email / notes
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				

If I cannot reach my parent

Use this section to create a just-in-case plan before there is an urgent moment. You may never need it, but having names, numbers, access details, and escalation steps written down can reduce panic if your parent does not answer.

Urgent safety note: Call 911 or local emergency services right away if you believe your parent may be in immediate danger, may have fallen, may be experiencing a medical emergency, may be unable to get to the phone, or if the situation feels urgent. Do not ask a neighbor, friend, or family member to enter a situation that may be unsafe.

Parent's usual check-in pattern				
First steps before escalating				

#	Just-in-case contact/access item	Name / office / location	Phone	Notes
1				
2				
3				
4				

Use the contact/access table for: first nearby person to call, backup nearby person to call, key/code/safe access, and building manager/front desk/community office.

Local police non-emergency number	
Local fire/EMS non-emergency number	
When we will call 911 or emergency services	

Planning reminder: The goal is not to predict every emergency. The goal is to make the first few decisions easier if something feels wrong.

Medical communication access

Before there is an urgent need, ask each doctor's office, specialist, hospital system, pharmacy, and insurance plan what authorization, HIPAA release, portal access, or representative documentation is required so trusted family members or helpers can receive information when appropriate.

Important access note: Requirements can vary by office, facility, provider, plan, state, and situation. This checklist is for organizing questions and contacts only. It is not legal, medical, financial, or care-management advice.

#	Doctor / office / facility	Phone	Who is authorized?	Release on file?	Date confirmed / notes
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					

Home access and emergency plan

Who has a spare key or safe access?	
Emergency entry instructions or lockbox notes	
Trusted neighbor / building contact	
Alarm, gate, or building access notes	
Pet care instructions if parent is hospitalized	
Utility shutoff / landlord / maintenance contact	

Services and daily needs

- ☐ Transportation options identified
- ☐ Meal delivery or food support identified
- ☐ Pharmacy and medication refill process known
- ☐ Home safety concerns noted
- ☐ Local aging agency or county resource identified
- ☐ Backup caregiver/helper identified
- ☐ Important papers location known
- ☐ Bill/payment awareness discussed
- ☐ Emergency information sheet completed
- ☐ Family communication plan discussed

Additional daily needs, worries, or service gaps	
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Action tracker

Turn worries into smaller next steps. Mark urgent items as Now.

Safety note: If your parent may be in immediate danger, cannot access food, has urgent medication concerns, may be wandering, or has a medical emergency, contact emergency services or an appropriate qualified professional right away.

#	Concern / task	Priority (Now / Next / Later)	Who to contact	Next step / notes
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				